

Danh mục: blood_glucose

May 15, 2024

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Español

Manage Blood Sugar

Key points

Keep your blood sugar levels in your target range as much as possible.

This will help you prevent or delay serious health problems.

There are specific steps you can take to make blood sugar easier to manage.

Checking blood sugar

How do I check my blood sugar?

Use a blood sugar meter (also called a glucometer) or a continuous glucose monitor (CGM) to check your blood sugar

A blood sugar meter measures the amount of sugar in a small sample of blood, usually from your fingertip. A CGM uses a sensor inserted under the skin to measure your blood sugar every few minutes.

If you use a CGM, you'll still need to test daily with a blood sugar meter. This will help make sure your CGM readings are accurate.

When should I check my blood sugar?

How often you check your blood sugar depends on the type of diabetes

you have and if you take any diabetes medicines.

Typical times to check your blood sugar are:

When you first wake up, before you eat or drink anything.

Before a meal.

Two hours after a meal.

At bedtime.

If you have

type 1 diabetes

, have

type 2 diabetes

and take insulin, or often have low blood sugar, your doctor may want you to check your blood sugar more often, such as before and after you're physically active.

Your blood sugar target

A blood sugar target is the range you try to reach as much as possible. These are typical targets:

Before a meal: 80 to 130 mg/dL.

Two hours after the start of a meal: Less than 180 mg/dL.

Your blood sugar targets may be different depending on your age, any additional health problems you have, and other factors. Talk to your health care team about which targets are best for you.

What causes low blood sugar?

Blood sugar below 70 mg/dL is considered low. Low blood sugar (also called hypoglycemia) has many causes, including:

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Missing a meal

Taking too much insulin

Taking other diabetes medicines

Being more physically active than usual

Drinking alcohol

Keep Reading:

About Low Blood Sugar (Hypoglycemia)

What causes high blood sugar?

Many things can cause high blood sugar (hyperglycemia), including:

Being sick

Being stressed

Eating more than usual

Not taking enough insulin

If you're sick and your blood sugar is 240 mg/dL or above, use an over-the-counter ketone test kit to check for ketones.

Call your doctor if your ketones are high. High ketones can be an early sign of diabetic ketoacidosis (DKA).

DKA is a medical emergency

and needs to be treated immediately.

Keep Reading:

About Diabetic Ketoacidosis

Ways to manage your blood sugar

Eating a

healthy diet

, maintaining a healthy weight, and

getting regular physical activity

can all help. Other tips include:

Keep track of your blood sugar to see what makes it go up or down.

Eat at regular times, and don't skip meals.

Choose foods lower in calories, saturated fat, sugar, and salt.

Track your food, drink, and physical activity.

Drink water instead of juice or soda.

Limit alcoholic drinks (2 drinks or less a day for men, 1 drink or less a day for women).

For a sweet treat, choose fruit.

Control your food portions (for example, use the

plate method

How do carbohydrates (carbs) affect blood sugar?

Carbs in food make your blood sugar levels go higher after you eat them than when you eat proteins or fats. You can still eat carbs if you have diabetes. The amount you can have depends on your age, weight, activity level, and other factors.

Counting carbs

in foods and drinks is an important tool for managing blood sugar levels. Make sure to talk to your health care team about the best carb goals for you.

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